VA CLAIM SCOUT

Claims Intelligence

Quick Start Guide | Free for every veteran | No tech expertise needed

1 Gather Your Records

Upload **as many of these as you have.** More records = better analysis.

VA RECORDS

- **VA Blue Button Report** — your full VA medical history (most important)
- **Rating Decision Letters** — any past VA decisions on your claims
- **DD-214** — your military discharge paperwork

MEDICAL RECORDS

- **Community Care records** — VA-authorized outside providers
- **Private doctor records** — any outside diagnoses or treatment
- **C&P exam results** — compensation & pension exam reports

CORRESPONDENCE

- **Emails with your VSO or attorney** — advice and action items
- **Claim decision & denial letters** from the VA
- **Appeal filings** — HLR, Supplemental Claim, or BVA

Blue Button: *VA.gov → My HealtheVet → Health Records → VA Blue Button → Select All → Download PDF*

3 Upload Your Files

Upload everything you gathered to your chosen AI platform:

- **Claude & ChatGPT:** Click the paperclip icon 📎 in the chat box
- **NotebookLM:** Click "+ Add Source" — upload all files including **VA_Claim_Scout_v0.2.md**
- You can upload **multiple PDFs** — more records = deeper analysis

4 Type This & Press Enter

"Claim Scout, help."

That's it. VA Claim Scout will introduce itself, show you everything it can do, and ask where you want to start. Just follow its lead.

Once the analysis is done, ask for a report:

🖶 Print it
Right-click the response → Print or Save as PDF

✉ Email your VSO
"Claim Scout, draft an outreach message."

📋 Copy the report
Select all → Copy → Paste into Word or email

📋 C&P prep brief
"Claim Scout, prepare a C&P script."

2 Choose Your AI Platform

All work with this framework. Pick what feels right for you.

Claude (claude.ai) — ★ Recommended

claude.ai
Free tier available · Pro plan $20/month

✓ Best at medical & legal language
✓ Handles very long VA records well
✗ Free tier has message limits
✗ Less name recognition than ChatGPT

ChatGPT (chatgpt.com)

chatgpt.com
Free tier available · Plus plan $20/month

✓ Most widely known AI tool
✓ Generous free tier
✗ Less precise on legal detail
✗ Free version = older, weaker model

Google NotebookLM

notebooklm.google.com
Completely free · Requires a Google account

✓ 100% free, no subscription
✓ Stays tightly tied to your documents
✗ Steeper learning curve
✗ Less conversational feel

Google Gemini (gemini.google.com)

gemini.google.com
Free tier · Advanced plan $20/month

✓ Very large document capacity
✓ Good if you use Google products
✗ Less focused on medical/legal
✗ Advanced plan for best results

Microsoft Copilot — Limited

copilot.microsoft.com
Free with Windows · Pro $20/month

✓ Already on most Windows PCs
✓ No extra account needed
✗ Weaker on complex analysis
✗ Inconsistent with long documents

Meta AI / Perplexity — Not recommended

Free · Meta AI on Facebook & WhatsApp

✓ Familiar if you use Facebook
✓ Perplexity good for quick searches
✗ Not built for document analysis
✗ Will not run this framework well

⚠ Not legal, medical, or official VA advice. Bring all findings to a VSO or VA-accredited attorney before filing. Free VSO help: **1-800-827-1000** | Find a VSO: va.gov/ogc/apps/accreditation